

Something
FOR
NOTHING

A Novel By
Cherry

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To my Heavenly Father. I will never write a book without first giving You the glory and honor that is due Your name. You deserve the praise, and not only for what You've done, but for who You are! I love You. I thank You for this gift, and I'm so grateful that You chose me.

DEDICATION



*I dedicate this book to the one I made wait
forever...for forever.
I'm sorry!*

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1

NOTHING IS PROMISED



7 he bells chimed as the door opened announcing

Autumn's arrival.

"Welcome to Sherry's, the best restaurant in all of North Carolina." The bright smile on the hostesses face was warm and genuine. "How many in your party tonight?"

"Just one." Autumn answered glancing around the room.

"Well we're glad you made it here safely it's nasty out there," she said, offering Autumn a hand towel. "Care to dry yourself off?"

"Thank you." Autumn said, accepting the towel and using it to pat dry her face and the parts of her long curly afro that hadn't shrank due to the rainy Charlotte evening.

"You look beautiful." The hostess said admiring Autumn's strapless emerald green evening gown.

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“Thank you. I’m a little overdressed, but that’s okay.” Autumn glanced around the room of casually dressed people ready to enjoy the show. Looking in the window at her reflection she saw her 5’6, 173 pound frame and smiled at her slight belly pudge that wasn’t too much for her control top panties to conceal. Her gorgeous honey brown complexion and light brown eyes complemented her formal gown.

“I can seat you wherever you’d like. We’re not very busy tonight.”

“Any table near the stage would be fine.”

“Perfect. Please follow me right this way.”

Autumn didn’t care where they were going, as long as once they got there, she would have time to sit down and try to figure things out.

Dabbing her face with the towel Autumn was thankful for the thunderstorm that was rocking the sky outside. The rain was a wonderful cover for her tears, and the dim lighting in the jazz and blues bar would allow her tears to go unnoticed.

Arriving at the table Autumn tossed her wet jacket over the back of one of the empty chairs before accepting the menu. “Enjoy your evening,” the chipper hostess said.

“Thank you.”

Autumn sat down then rested her head in the palm of her hands. She was trying her best to hold it together, even if only until she ordered her drink and it sat in front of her.

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On that cold and rainy February night Autumn was faced with the truth and a revelation. For the first time in her life she recognized true love, and was tormented by the fact that she would probably never get it back. Everything had gone wrong and all she had to show for the last year and a half was wasted time. She'd single-handedly torn down her own home. *I have nothing left to build with*, she thought, sighing deeply.

“Good evening. Welcome to Sherry’s. I’m Chris and I’ll be your server. Can I start you off with a drink?”

“Hi Chris I’ll have a chilled glass of brown sherry please.”

“Yes ma’am. You have a menu so I take it you’re dining with us tonight?”

“More than likely, but I’m not ready to order. If you don’t mind, I’ll look over the menu until I make a decision?”

“Absolutely. Take your time. I’ll put your drink order in.”

Autumn showed her gratitude with a smile before Chris turned and walked away. She loved the class and style of Sherry’s. Everything was the right amount of perfect. The bar was tucked away in the corner under soft red lighting. The upper level had leather booths that lined the wall. The lower level, three steps down from the bar, had several square tables covered with black linen tablecloths and elegant white

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Chiavari chairs with black seat cushions. There were small bouquets of red roses in short square vases on every table.

Autumn watched as the band set up on the stage that was front and center. She was interested in any and everything that would take her mind off the hurt and pain she felt. The karma that had boomeranged back to her was justified, and she deserved every bit of it. She sniffled as she felt the tears return.

Seeing Chris walking to her table Autumn quickly dried her eyes. “Your glass of brown sherry.”

“Thank you.” She said as he sat the glass in front of her. “I’m good for now. I’ll probably order something to eat after another glass or two.”

“No problem. I’ll leave you to it and come back to check on you a little later.”

Autumn smiled her thanks. She was grateful for the space, Lord knows she needed it. All she wanted was the music and the extremely high alcohol content of the sherry to help her forget what a fool she’d been.

Raising the glass to her lips Autumn took a long slow sip. The wine was strong, sweet and just what she needed to numb the regret that consumed her. She was the sorriest she’d ever been in her life and she had only herself to blame. Following what she thought was her heart had caused her to start a war that wasn’t worth the fight. And she'd not only lost the battle, it looked like she'd lost the war as well.

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The soft sound of the saxophone took her back to a place and time when real love had been offered to her without limits and conditions. Like a fool she'd taken it for granted. *Damn I fucked up* she thought. She now realized that kind of love was exclusive and didn't come around every day. The thought of losing to an illusion was killing her. She silently thanked God that the band was drowning out her sniffles and sobs as they played the melody to "I Wanna Be Your Man" by Zapp and Roger Troutman. That song was the very first vinyl record Jacob ever played for her. She smiled through her tears at the memory of him fresh out of the shower, a towel wrapped around his waist as he sang to her, using a brush as a microphone. That was his offer for them to be exclusive. "So can I?" he'd asked.

"Can you what?" she replied.

"Can I be your man?"

Without hesitation she'd responded. "Of course you can. In my mind you already are. Thanks for making it official." She'd then sealed their relationship with a kiss.

There wasn't a lot she would bet on, but she was sure that the love he once had for her was now gone.

Autumn scanned the room of middle-aged men and became terrified at the thought of starting over. She'd gone to Sherry's to be closer to Jacob, at least in spirit. If she were lucky, maybe he would be there too and when he saw her he'd remember what their love used to be. As hopeful as the

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thought was she doubted it. She'd spoken words that couldn't be taken back. Had she only known that the grass that had looked greener on the other side was just artificial turf, she would've never left him.

"Are you ladies and gentlemen ready to groove and have a good time tonight?" The sultry lead singer, with a warm honey brown complexion and full lips, cooed into the mic.

The crowds cheer was a clear indication that they were definitely ready. Autumn could barely muster up the energy to clap, much less yell in response. Instead tonight, the crowd would serve as her voice.

"Has anyone out there ever been in love before?" Once again the crowd yelled back in response. "Do you mind if tonight we take a little journey through a time when I once loved and had love? And I mean some *good* love.... And you know what I did with all that good loving?" She paused to run her hand over her short blond afro. "I fucked that shit up! Now he's gone...and the worst part about him being gone is?" she paused again for effect. "*Baby* I want him back.... *Oh!*" she sang as the drummer stepped on the bass causing the boom.

Autumn looked up. The singer now had her full attention. With only a few words she had pulled into Autumn's driveway and stepped right up onto her front porch.

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“My name is Love and this is my amazing band On You. Why did we choose it? Because every time we get together and do a show we get to love *on you*. So is it all right if we love on you a little bit tonight?” she whispered into the mic. The crowd clapped, whistled, and yelled their agreement. “Good because...I need somebody to talk to. See I just...I just gotta get this off my chest. Now the saying usually goes a good man is...?” Love held out her mic to the audience.

“Hard to find,” they finished.

“Right! But one thing that never gets talked about is when a woman has a good man and she messes up.” It sounded to Autumn like every man in the place cheered. “When he was mine I didn’t love him right.” Love sang that line with so much power it pierced Autumn’s soul. Tears slid down her cheeks as the passion behind the lyrics forced her to remember the very first time she laid eyes on Jacob.

Four years ago

“We haven’t slept in over thirty-eight hours. I can’t believe you’re not going straight home after just getting off the plane.” Lynn shouted on the phone.

“That’s what a trip to Los Angeles does to you. When I finally do get home, I’m not coming out for at least two days. So I might as well go ahead and get what I need now.”

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Autumn said, whipping her car into a parking space in the supermarket lot.

“That’s not all LA does to you. Can you believe Erica and Brittany left with those three dudes from the casino the last night? Then came running in the room two and half hours before our flight back to Charlotte talking about ‘give us 10 minutes.’ Brittany had blue eye shadow smeared all over her face looking like the Na’vi, one of them aliens from *Avatar* and shit.”

“Girl you are crazy as hell. You say she looked like an avatar?”

“You know she did.”

“And you know that LA is like Vegas...what happens in LA stays in LA.”

“Yeah but you were there with me so that means I can talk about it with you.”

“You right and Erica’s fishnet stockings, didn’t have no net in between her thighs. I was like, why even bother to put ‘em back on?”

“Put ‘em back on. Autumn she never took the damn things off. One of them dudes must’ve ripped through them for easier access. And you know it was granted,” Lynn said before they busted out laughing.

“Girl stop it. I don’t have the minutes to do this with you. Let me call you back so I can run in and out of this store

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real quick,” she said hopping out of the car. “We can continue this when I get home.”

Lynn had been her personal assistant long enough to know that there was nothing quick about anything Autumn did. “Chile please. We were in LA for five days. You were promoting and selling your art for more than ten hours each day. You’re tired, jet-lagged, and delusional. There won’t be anything ‘in and out’ about you stopping at that grocery store so you can stock up and go home. I don’t know who you think you’re fooling.”

“Bye Lynn.” Autumn said about to hang up.

“Hey wait. Before you go.”

“What is it?”

“Yeah...don’t call me for three days. I’m serious. For three days I don’t want to hear from you. Don’t text me, don’t email me, don’t Facetime me, don’t nothing me. Got it?”

“Is that how you really feel? How about I don’t pay you, don’t insure you, don’t bonus you, don’t travel you all over this world, don’t—”

“Okay, stop right there. On second thought if you need me...I’ll be right here.” Lynn cut Autumn off not wanting her to continue, especially before she got to the company car, gas card, tablet, laptop, and phone.

“Oh okay.... Bye girl.”

“Bye!” Lynn said, ending the call.

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Thirty minutes later, Autumn was still thinking about their call as she steered her shopping cart across the parking lot to her car. She didn't know what she was going to do with Kaliyan "Lynn" Gordon. She was the feistiest, funniest, most real and down-to-earth Cambodian woman she'd ever met. Autumn loved Lynn like a sister and sometimes forgot that she was Cambodian, until she looked at her and saw the distinctive slant to her eyes, her golden tanned complexion, full lips, and her jet black waist-length hair. Hearing her you'd never know it. Lynn was raised in America around black people and never learned to speak her native language. But she was smart and efficient, quick on her feet, and got the job done to perfection. Not to mention that her, gorgeous looks and knock-out body could change any man's "no" to a "yes" with a simple face to face or video conference meeting. Autumn didn't know what she would do without her. In the past three years since she'd hired Lynn her business had quadrupled. Lynn had been a district manager for a top art agency and brought along clients with her that consisted of the mayor's wife, top judges, professional athletes of all sports, and other elite clientele, and all of them had referred their friends and associates. It was to the point that special orders were coming in daily and the paintings in her gallery were flying off the walls. It had been bananas for the last year but they both loved it.

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She didn't know what she was talking about, Autumn thought, pushing the cart to the trunk of her car. When she let the handle go to open her trunk the cart rolled back down the incline and hit the door of an older modeled Mercedes. Autumn hurried after the errant cart hoping the owner of the vehicle was not inside. Her hope dimmed as the driver's side door opened and out stepped a tall handsome honey complexioned man. He had a long oval face, thick eyebrows, almond shaped eyes, and a neatly trimmed mustache with a little bit of peach fuzz at the bottom of his chin. He had a head full of short thick black hair that blended down well into a fade. His eyelashes were long and thick and complimented his dark brown eyes.

"I'm so sorry." Autumn apologized not knowing what to expect but she prepared for him to give her attitude. Although it was an older model, by its pristine condition, she could tell that he still took care and pride in his ride. The paint shone, the tinted windows sparkled, and the wheels had a high gloss from at least two coats of tire shine. She didn't know if he'd just left the car wash but he surely hadn't been that long gone from it. Her car, on the other hand, was far from clean. She could only imagine how pissed he must be that she'd banged into his door. To her surprise instead of attitude he greeted her with a smile that uncovered beautiful straight white teeth that revealed the chubbiness of his cheeks.

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“No need to apologize beautiful. It’s just a car and accidents happen. I don’t get upset over materialist things. That’s what I have insurance for.”

His kind and gentle response was soothing and made her smile. *That’s what I’m talking about*, Autumn thought, doing well to remember that he’d called her beautiful like it was her name, and how easily and naturally it had flowed from his lips.

“Let me help you,” he said, grabbing the cart and pushing it back up the hill.

Autumn fell behind him on purpose to get a full glimpse of what this mystery man was working with. He had to be about 6’3 maybe 6’4. He wasn’t a big dude maybe a little smaller than husky, and he could thank his height for helping out with that. He did have a well-shaped cute butt with a little bit of a paunch, but it clearly wasn’t anything six weeks of eating right and exercise couldn’t get rid of.

“Which car is yours?” he asked as they reached the top of the parking lot.

“The one with the open trunk,” Autumn answered.

“I see you got you a nice little TLX,” he said, maneuvering the cart carefully between the other vehicles to stop at her car.

“Thank you,” Autumn said loading the few bags into her trunk.

“What’s your name?”

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“Autumn Hayes, and yours?”

“Jacob Towers. And, even though you just slammed your cart into my back door it’s still a pleasure meeting you, Autumn Hayes.”

“I’m sorry Jacob.”

“Nah. You’re too beautiful to be sorry. Matter of fact I’m sorry for *you*,” he said looking at her car and shaking his head.

“Why are you shaking your head and why are you sorry?”

“My apologies.... I’m just trying to figure out how your man allows you to ride around in such a dirty car?” He was looking at all the junk in the back seat and on the floor.

“It’s not that bad. I’ve been meaning to take it to get washed but I’ve been so busy, plus I often work out of my car.”

“Oh no, it’s *absolutely* that bad. But that’s something your man is supposed to take care of. I mean the car is brown.”

Autumn didn’t want to laugh especially when he was clowning her but she couldn’t help it. “It’s not brown it’s silver,” she shot back.

“What? Get the fuck outta here,” Jacob joked, laughing with her.

“It’s *not* brown.”

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“And it damn sure ain’t silver. But you didn’t answer my question. Not that I deserve an answer but it would be nice to know.”

“Know what?”

“Why a man who is lucky enough to have a woman as beautiful as you got his lady riding around in this dirty car?”

“Well if you must know. I don’t have a man. But that’s no excuse. I really didn’t think it was that bad...but since you mentioned it and twice at that I’m—”

“Going to let me do something about it,” he interjected. “That’s if you’ll let me. Since I mentioned it, and *twice* at that. Will you meet me up the street at Suds City tomorrow at 2:00 PM so I can get you all cleaned up Ms. Hayes?”

Autumn contemplated the question. *He seems nice and has been a gentlemen, plus my car could use the washing. And it’s a public place so I’d be safe if he tries anything.*

When she didn’t answer Jacob said, “You look a little skeptical. Don’t worry, you’re safe with me. You have no reason to be afraid. I’m just trying to get you all cleaned up so you’ll look like you belong to somebody ‘cause you should. Since you don’t have a man and all, maybe one day soon you’ll be accepting applications.”

Autumn smiled. “I guess it all depends on who’s inquiring and applying?” She couldn’t believe she was that

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quick on her feet but she liked it. And judging by the smile on Jacob's face so did he.

"I'll tell you what Autumn. How about you give me your number and I'll follow up with you tomorrow so you won't have me waiting at the car wash, in the Charlotte heat, looking stupid?"

"I would never do that." Autumn said as she gave him her digits. She had no idea what she was thinking. Jacob was very attractive but looked like he couldn't be more than twenty-five *maybe* twenty-six. And there was no way she could entertain the likes of a man that young. But his charm was so refreshing, which was a welcome and pleasant change from most men who laid their game on too thick. *What the hell?*

Jacob hit send as soon as he added her number to his contact list. A second later her phone vibrated in her purse. "That's my number," he said hearing the vibration. "Now, when I reach out to you tomorrow you can't play me like you don't know who I am." Autumn smiled and shook her head. "Oh, and can you do me a favor?" Jacob asked.

"What's that?"

"Can you please clean all this junk out of the back seat so I can do a good job and make you want to see me again?"

"It's not junk," Autumn frowned.

"My apologies...can you please take out all of those very important documents that are scattered all over your

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backseat and floor so I can do you and your car a favor? Oh, and please don't cancel... 'cause clearly you and the car need me."

"I'm not going to cancel."

"Good, then can you make time for lunch afterwards too?" Jacob then winked, before turning and walking away.

Autumn closed the trunk and slid into her car wondering what she'd gotten herself in to and what tomorrow would hold with Mr. Jacob Towers. *The last time I loved I nearly died from a broken heart.* Autumn started the car, then she just sat there, jet-lagged and feeling delusional because she knew *nothing* just happened. Love didn't work out for her. Fate saw to it that she would only get so close to her happily ever after before things went horribly wrong.

"I don't see why we can't just get married and start a family now." Ryan said looking at her. He was as serious as a heart attack.

"Because we're both trying to get our businesses off the ground remember," Autumn said, hoping he would buy it.

He'd been bringing up getting married a lot lately though she didn't know why. This was the third time this week. *Where was all this marriage and baby talk coming from all of*

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sudden? Last I checked we have dreams and goals and timelines set. I don't have time for a baby right now.

“Ryan, how are you watching the road *and* looking at me?” She was trying to get him to stop glaring at her. Autumn breathed a sigh of relief when he focused his attention back on the highway. It’s not that she didn’t love him or didn’t want what he was offering, just not right away. She wanted them to grow together, and travel the world experiencing different countries and cultures. She wanted them to help each other grind through the difficulties and struggles of building their businesses and relationship into a dynamic dynasty that the world respected. In her mind the family he wanted would then be easier to manage, not while they were still in the thick of it.

“I need gas,” Ryan said pulling into a station and up to the pump.”

“Good I can get some candy to take into the movie. You want something?” Autumn asked admiring the entirety of this man who held her whole world in his hands. She could see that he was still upset with her answer. “Hey you,” she said, caressing his face. “I love you and I promise to be your bride and give you as many babies as you want if you can just wait two years. Please?”

“You begging?”

“More like pleading.”

“Same thing.”

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“One sounds better than the other,” Autumn said, before she explored his lips with her tongue. “Trust me, in two years you won’t even remember having this conversation. We have time for everything you want...that *we* want because, I want it too and with you.”

“You’re right.” Ryan confirmed the acceptance of his offer with the passion in his kiss.

“Be right back,” Autumn said as she got out of the car and ran into the store.

She loved everything about Ryan. He was exactly her type—tall, dark, and handsome, with strong masculine features mixed with patience and an engaging personality. Autumn felt like royalty with him. He showered her with consideration; always opening doors for her and surprising her with gifts. His affection for her was unmistakable, in fact, it was near to overflowing. Autumn loved being with him and the quality time they spent together was wonderful. But the thing she loved most was that his hustle outmatched hers. He was also encouraging and incredibly motivating. She knew they were headed to the top and had decided it would only take two years for them to get there, if that.

“Will that be all?” the cashier asked.

“Yes, thanks,” Autumn said. As she prepared to swipe her card she glanced outside at Ryan and froze. *No no no...* She dropped her card on the counter and ran to the door. An SUV was airborne and careening across the highway

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into the gas station. “*Ryan!*” Autumn screamed, pushing the door open. Seeing the fear on her face he spun around and saw the vehicle heading toward him. He knew it was too late to run. He turned back to Autumn with an angelic smile on his face. Ryan then closed his eyes as the vehicle crashed into the gas pump. “*No!*” Autumn screamed. The force from the blast knocked her back into the store. The glass from the doors and windows shattered around her as the heat from the explosion scorched her face and body. The last thing she saw before passing out was Ryan engulfed in smoke and flames.

“*No!*” Autumn screamed, frantically sitting up in bed. She was panting and in a cold sweat. She tried to calm her breathing and slow her heart rate. Bringing her knees to her chest, she wrapped her arms around her legs and rested her head against her thighs. Though she was no longer panicked she could not stop the pain. Gasping for air between her sobs, she tried to forget the nightmare of the worst day of her life. She wanted to stop having it, but she couldn’t. The nightmare replayed itself over and over again since it happened two years ago. She knew it was only a dream but every time she woke up, it brought the same heartache and pain she had felt the day she’d lost the love of her life. Autumn screamed between the sobs wracking her body but found no release.

Watching Ryan die had killed a piece of her too. When she regained consciousness people were dragging her

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to safety as the flames grew higher. Seeing the fire swallow him whole was an image that took almost a year for her to not see every time she closed her eyes. She'd been helpless to save the only man she'd ever loved. Even after years of therapy and countless counseling sessions she still felt a deep emptiness mixed with an all-consuming misery. Autumn had tried her hardest over the years to bury her grief like the grave she'd watched them lower Ryan into. That day changed her life forever. Her heart didn't beat the same afterwards. Not only did she no longer make promises, but she now started many sentences with "I can't promise you anything." Because she knew that nothing was promised. Her relationship with God was healing though she still had doubts from time to time.

I should've said yes, she thought, her eyes filling with tears. If I'd said yes, we might not have stopped. We didn't need gas, he just wanted to pull over and talk. Breathing slowly Autumn closed her eyes against her tears. It was the worst mistake she'd ever made when it came to love. She then gave in to the despair and let it all out; all the anger, sadness, and regret. I should've said yes, that I'd marry him. Oh God I never let him know how much I loved him or how much he meant to me. I never told him how much I wanted to have children with him. And now it's too late. Autumn fell back into the bed sobbing uncontrollably. The sense of loss was almost unbearable. There were so many things she wanted to tell him that she'd never get the chance to say. It

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had been the hardest day of her life and her greatest obstacle to overcome, and to this day she still wasn't sure how she'd managed it. Or if she'd even managed to do it at all. Those were some of the longest days she'd ever had to get through. She remembered the times she'd gone seeking death attempting to run from the guilt that came with wondering why him and not her. Why hadn't she died with Ryan? *It should've been me too. I never wanted to leave you. Life was so much easier when you were here. I still love you so much. I don't want to have to move on but God knows I'm lonely. I don't want to be alone anymore, but I don't want to betray you.*

Autumn still questioned why God didn't also take her that day, wondering why she'd been left behind. She would give anything to be with Ryan again, to be back in the space of love that came without judgement and with lots of forgiveness. Nothing was the same without him. No one touched her mind and body the way he had. Sometimes she could still feel the softness of his hands and smell the scent of his skin, especially on days when missing him was overwhelming and she questioned her strength to go on. There were days she had even called his phone hoping that it had all been a terrible nightmare and he'd pick up. It had gotten so bad that the man who had his number would answer and say, "he's not here. I'm sorry," before politely hanging up.

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Autumn was torn for the first time since losing Ryan. Though she vowed to never again love anyone the way she loved him, there was something intriguing about Jacob Towers, something she wanted to explore. *Am I ready?* she wondered. *Clearly I'm not if I'm still having the dream. But I haven't had it in over a year why would it happen the night after meeting Jacob? Is it because I'm not ready? Or is this my way of still holding on? Ryan would want me to love again, at least that's what they say. But it's so hard.* Not many could relate to having to love again after death stole your heart away. Death's betrayal was like no other because it doesn't give the opportunity for closure or the chance to make wrong things right. *Like it or not you're going to meet Jacob, so you might as well try to get some rest.*

Autumn groaned when she heard her cell vibrate on the nightstand. She wasn't ready to face the world just yet. Blindly reaching until she felt the phone, she rolled over to see who wanted what and why. The text was from a number not in her contacts so she knew it had to be Jacob. Not knowing what to expect she opened the message.

Hello there. I hope you're up cleaning out that brown car.

Autumn looked at the time. *How the hell is it 12:45 in the afternoon already?* There was no way she was going to make it there by two o'clock especially knowing she was gonna stay in bed until 3:00.

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She typed back: *Lol not yet because I'm super tired and jet-lagged. Can we meet at 4:00?*

I can do 4:00...see you then.

Good, nothing like a compromising man who understands, she thought, setting her alarm then drifting back to sleep.

The ringing of the alarm was torture to Autumn's ears. *Who would've thought that a three-hour time difference could wreak so much havoc?* She didn't want to get up but she'd told Jacob that she wouldn't cancel. A part of her wondered why she even cared what she'd told him. She didn't know him from the paint on the wall and if she wanted to change her mind, it was her prerogative. But if she was nothing else she was a woman of her word. And he'd been nice to her and treated her with respect when he could've been an asshole after she'd dented his car. *Plus I haven't enjoyed a man's company in a while so this could be good for me,* she thought, pushing herself out of bed.

Good thing they were just going to wash some cars, which meant she wouldn't have to put much effort into an outfit. Autumn showered then dried off. If she could get out of the house in the next twenty-five minutes Jacob wouldn't have to wait. She couldn't believe that she had agreed to meet a man she barely knew, but she liked the spontaneity of it. It was, fun, exciting and outside of the norm for her. Autumn was at a point in her life where she was living it to the fullest. If she wanted to do it, it was getting done. She was single and

Cherry

open to rewarding herself in her personal life to not become a workaholic. She wanted a balance and this was a great start.

Autumn brushed her curly hair back from her face. She admired her flawless skin, which didn't require a touch of makeup, but that didn't stop her from lining her eyes, applying mascara and adding a touch of clear lip gloss. She then slipped on a pair of jean shorts, a white fitted tank, and a pair of aqua and purple sneakers. Giving herself one last glance in the full-length mirror she grabbed her purse off the bed and headed to the garage. Sitting in the car she typed, *On my way*, then sent the text to Jacob before pulling out of the garage. She was looking forward to finding out what Jacob Towers had to offer.